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In Our Simulation Era: Transitioning from Passive to Immersive Training

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Background

- Many hospitals traditionally utilize a "Skills Fair" approach to perform annual competency training for nurses and nursing support staff.
- This often is completed as passive "stations" that staff travel to with minimal interaction required.
- This format can lead to disengagement and often does not appeal to nurses' learning styles.
- Based on feedback from previous learning needs assessments and evidence-based practice findings, incorporating simulation-based training actively engages staff and improves confidence and knowledge.
- Simulation-based training is an essential component of education for bedside nurses; simulation can include procedural skills and complex nursing assessments and interventions.[1]
- High fidelity simulations have been shown to improve professional nurses' self-confidence.[2]
- Based on the organization's annual learning needs assessment, nurses identified their preferred method of education was through hands-on, simulation-based educational offerings.

Aim

- The purpose of this quality improvement project was to increase nurses' knowledge of critical care concepts while increasing confidence implementing advanced nursing skills within their patient population through tailored simulation-based training.

Methods

- The clinical nurse specialists (CNSs) and staff development educators outlined low-volume, high-risk clinical scenarios to include the organization's annual requirements in addition to patient population specific competencies.
- The intervention included two separate simulations (thirty minutes each including debrief) tailored to required competencies based on progressive or critical care population.
- Following the simulations, the staff completed interactive, hands-on demonstration with equipment specific to their area.
- In addition to simulation, hands-on demonstration, and discussion the staff were provided with reference guides for nursing therapies.
- The learners included nurses (bedside nurses, clinical unit leaders, unit managers, house shift managers) and technical care associates (TCAs) on progressive and critical care units.
- Pre-and post-surveys were completed assessing the nurses' and TCAs level of confidence, knowledge, and effectiveness of simulation-based training compared to passive learning modalities.

Findings

- Post-surveys (n= 158) demonstrated a 17.6% increase in staff feeling extremely confident caring for their specific patient population compared to pre-survey (n= 165).
- Results also demonstrated a 20.7% increase in staff feeling very knowledgeable caring for their specific patient population.
- Post-surveys demonstrated that 97% of staff felt all or most of the topics applied to their specialty area.
- Compared to previous years' annual competency training 97.2% of staff preferred this immersive education and competency validation.
- Based on positive staff feedback, this interactive, simulation-focused modality will continue to be offered annually.

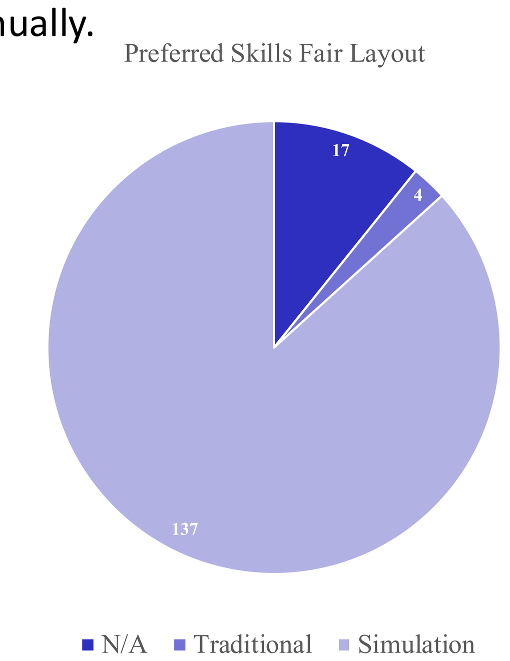

Figure 1. Post-survey Skills Fair layout preference.

Simulation Examples

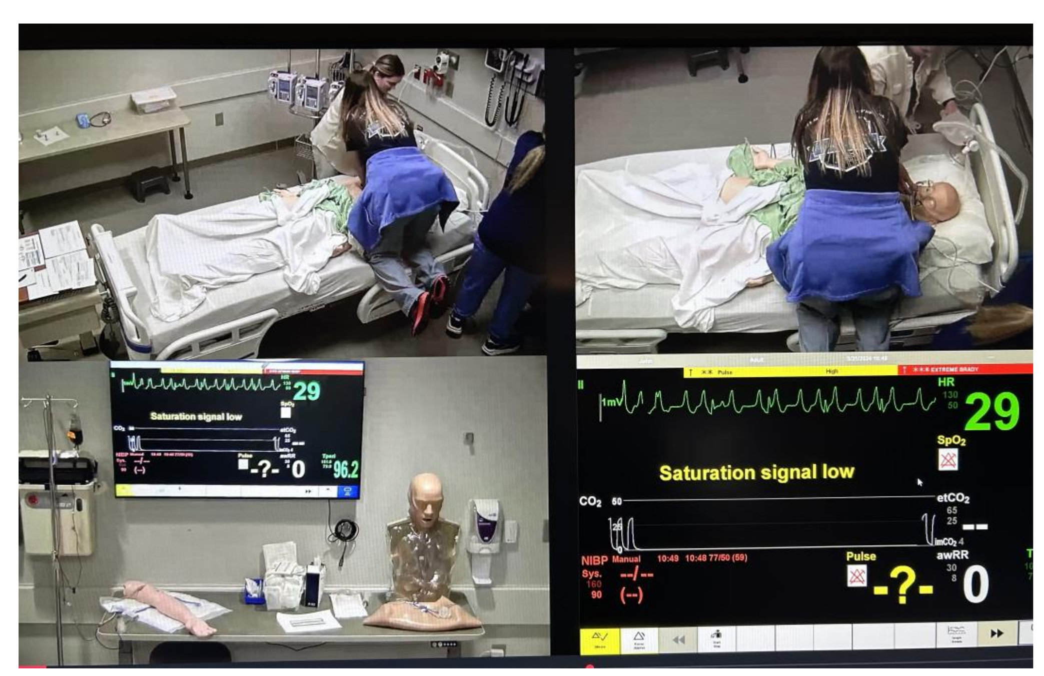

Figure 2. ICU Simulation resulting in cardiac arrest.

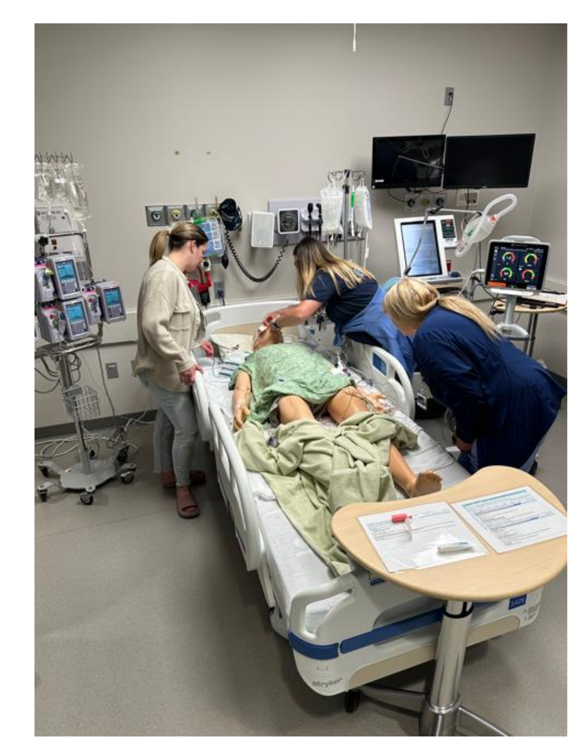

Figure 3. ICU Simulation post heart catheterization.

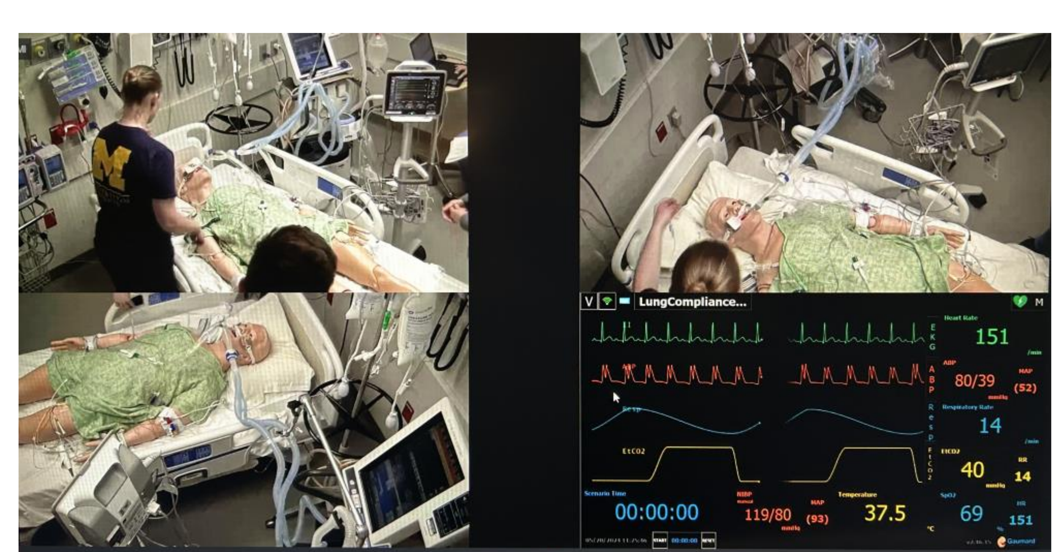

Figure 4. ICU Simulation post heart catheterization.

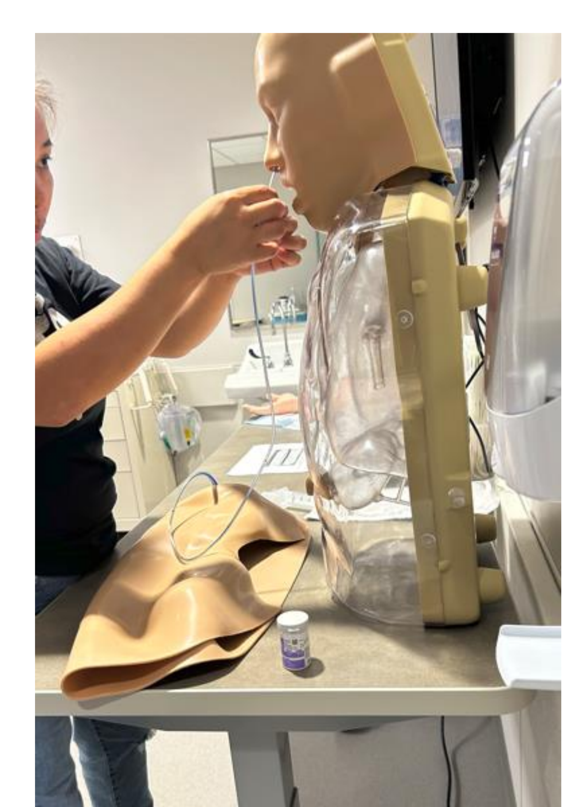

Figure 5. PCU hands-on nasogastric tube insertion.

Findings Continued

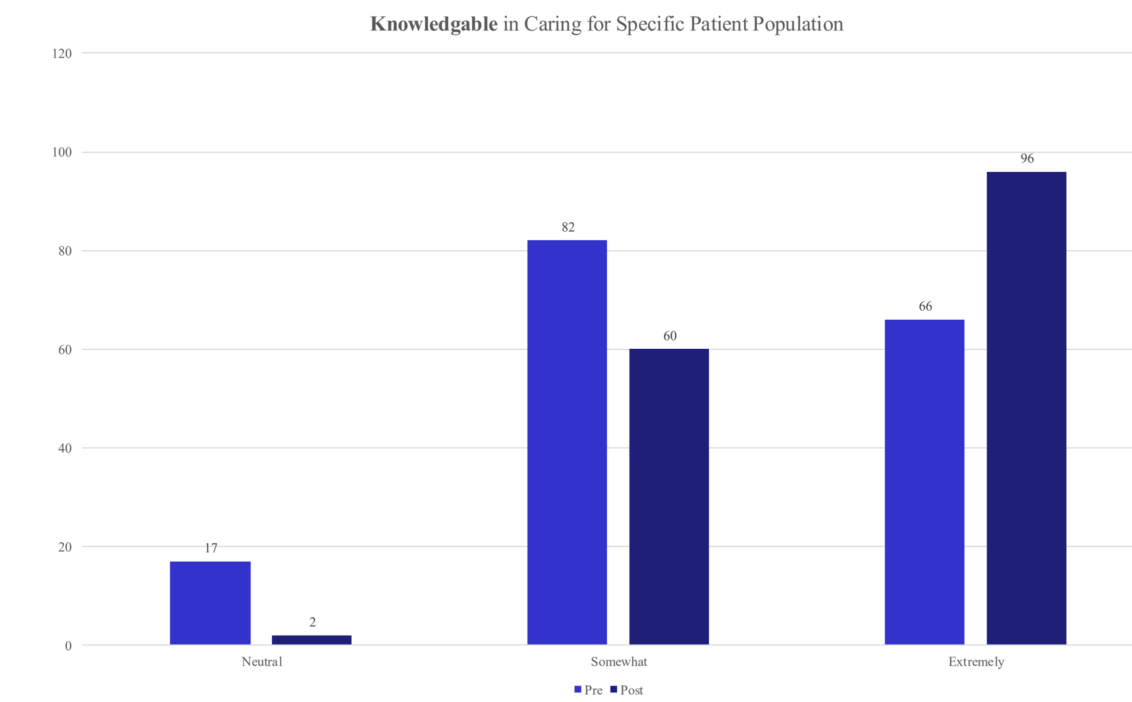

Figure 6. Outcomes from surveys related to knowledge.

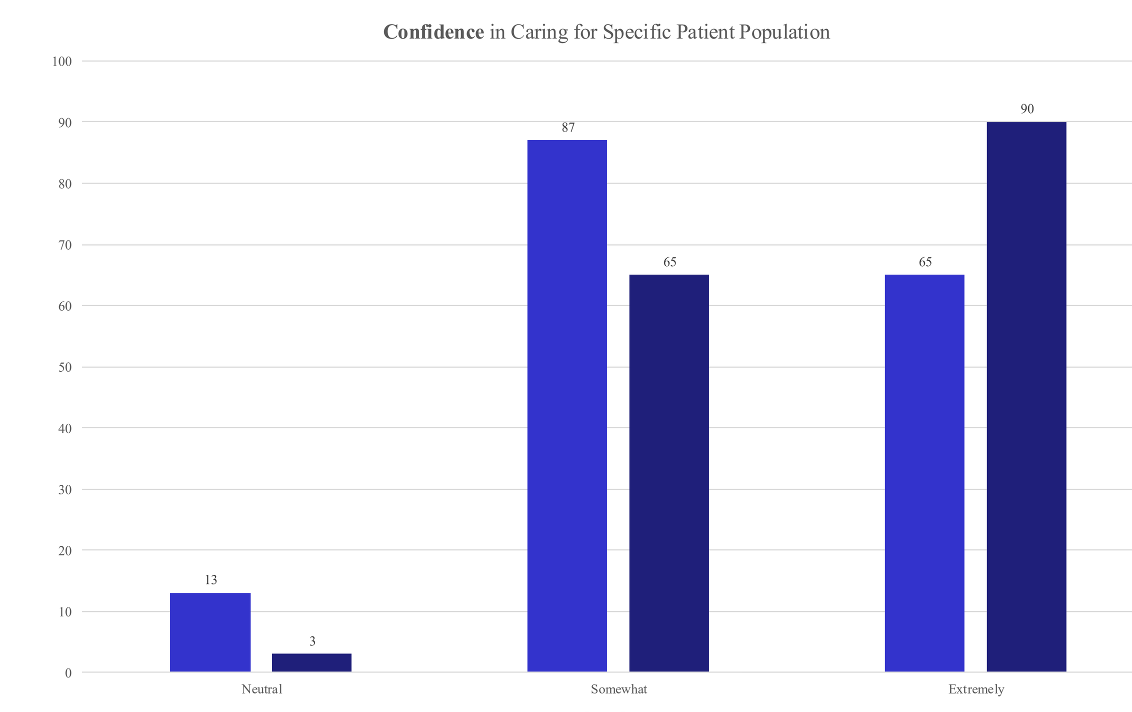

Figure 7. Outcomes from surveys related to confidence.

Implications

- Based on this quality improvement project, an interactive and simulation-focused format for a yearly Skills Fair increased confidence and knowledge and was preferred to a standard passive learning experience.
- This can help to shape future Skills Fair sessions and other learning opportunities for nurses.
- Clinical nurse specialists are integral to the education of clinical nurses in the hospital, and identifying the best way to educate nurses is key to success.
- Future CNSs can utilize the data from this quality improvement project to outline and create their own simulation and active learning sessions.

References

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